

Unit 1.0 – Communication: Theory and Practice

1.1 Communication: Role, Relevance, Elements

Communication is the process of exchanging information, ideas, thoughts, or feelings between two or more people through a common system of symbols, signs, or behaviour.

Role and Relevance: Communication is essential in every sphere of personal and professional life — it builds relationships, enables teamwork, facilitates decision-making, and is critical for career success in engineering and technical professions.

Elements of Communication (Context-Sender-Message-Channel-Receiver-Feedback):

Element	Description
Context	The situation/background in which communication occurs
Sender	The person who originates and sends the message
Message	The information/idea being communicated
Channel	The medium through which the message travels (speech, writing, email, etc.)
Receiver	The person who receives and interprets the message
Feedback	The receiver's response, confirming the message was understood

1.2 Process / Stages of Communication

1. **Ideation:** Forming an idea or thought in the sender's mind.
2. **Encoding:** Converting the idea into words, symbols, or gestures.
3. **Selecting a proper channel:** Choosing the medium (spoken, written, visual).
4. **Transmission:** Sending the encoded message through the chosen channel.
5. **Receiving:** The receiver perceives the message.
6. **Decoding:** The receiver interprets/ understands the message.
7. **Giving Feedback:** The receiver responds, completing the communication loop.

1.3 The 7 Cs of Effective Communication

Principle	Meaning
Considerate	Keep the receiver's viewpoint, needs, and feelings in mind
Correct	Use grammatically correct language and accurate facts
Concrete	Be specific and clear, avoiding vague statements
Concise	Convey the message in the fewest possible words

Clear	Use simple, easily understandable language
Complete	Include all necessary information
Courteous	Be polite, respectful, and friendly in tone

1.4 Barriers to Communication

Barrier	Description	Example
Physiological	Due to physical/biological limitations of sender/receiver	Hearing impairment, speech defect
Physical	Due to environmental/distance factors	Noise, distance, poor network
Psychological	Due to mental state — emotions, prejudice, stress	Anger, fear, lack of attention
Mechanical	Due to faults in the medium/equipment	Poor telephone line, technical fault
Semantic/Language	Due to misinterpretation of words/symbols	Jargon, ambiguous words, different languages
Cultural	Due to differences in customs, values, and norms	Different gestures meaning different things across cultures

Ways to overcome/minimize barriers: Use simple and clear language, active listening, seek feedback, choose the appropriate channel, be empathetic, eliminate noise/distractions, and be culturally sensitive.

1.5 Case Studies (IKS)

- **Bhagwat Geeta — Krishna-Arjun conversation:** Demonstrates effective communication through patient listening, clear explanation, and resolving the receiver's doubts — Krishna addresses Arjun's confusion and despair with logical, empathetic counsel before the war.
 - **Mahabharata — Kauravas-Pandavas dialogue:** Illustrates communication breakdown caused by ego, mistrust, and psychological barriers, leading to conflict — a case study in failed negotiation and communication barriers.
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Unit 2.0 – Types of Communication

2.1 Based on Organizational Structure

- **Formal Communication:** Follows official channels/hierarchy of an organization.
- *Vertical:* Flows upward (subordinate to superior) or downward (superior to subordinate).
- *Horizontal:* Flows between people at the same level (peer to peer).
- *Diagonal:* Flows between people at different levels and different departments.
- **Informal Communication (Grapevine):** Unofficial communication that flows without following formal channels, often through casual conversations; can be fast but may distort information.

2.2 Based on Method of Expression

Verbal Communication: - **Oral:** Spoken words — face-to-face conversation, telephone, meetings. Advantage: immediate feedback, personal touch. Disadvantage: no permanent record. - **Written:** Letters, emails, reports, memos. Advantage: permanent record, precise. Disadvantage: slower feedback.

Non-verbal Communication: Communication without words, through codes such as:

Code	Meaning
Kinesics	Body language — gestures, posture, facial expressions
Chronemics	Use of time in communication (punctuality, pace)
Proxemics	Use of physical space/distance between communicators
Haptics	Communication through touch
Vocalics/Paralanguage	Tone, pitch, volume, pace of voice
Artifacts	Communication through objects/appearance (dress, accessories)
Graphic and Visual	Communication through charts, graphs, diagrams, images

Role of tables, charts and graphs: They present numerical/comparative data visually, making complex information easier and faster to understand than plain text.

2.3 Based on Number of People Involved

- **Intrapersonal Communication:** Communication within oneself (self-talk, internal reflection, decision-making).
- **Interpersonal Communication:** Communication between two individuals.
- **Group Communication:** Communication among three or more people.
- *Advantages:* Pooling of ideas, collective decision-making, wider participation.
- *Disadvantages:* Time-consuming, possibility of conflict, dominance by a few members.

2.4 Case Studies (IKS)

Bhagwat Geeta's various conversations between Krishna and Arjun illustrate **interpersonal formal communication** with strong **non-verbal cues** (Krishna's calm tone/Vocalics, his choice of the battlefield setting/Proxemics) used to convince and guide Arjun through a moral and emotional dilemma.

Unit 3.0 — Reading Comprehension

| Comprehension Skills

Reading comprehension is the ability to read text, process it, and understand its meaning — including identifying the central idea, vocabulary, sentence structures, idioms, and literary devices used by the author.

Key skills practiced through prescribed texts:

- **Glossary/Vocabulary building:** Identifying and noting new/difficult words from the text along with meanings.
- **Summarizing:** Condensing the central idea of a passage in one's own words without losing the essential meaning.
- **Types of sentences:** Recognizing simple, compound, and complex sentences within a text.
- **Idioms and phrases:** Identifying figurative expressions used by the author and understanding their contextual meaning.
- **Author biography:** Brief background of the writer's life and works, useful for contextual understanding.
- **Figures of speech:** Identifying devices like simile, metaphor, personification, alliteration used in the text.
- **Forms of poetry:** Classifying poems based on structure (sonnet, ode, blank verse, free verse).
- **Central idea/theme:** Expressing the core message of a poem or prose piece in one's own words.

| Prescribed Texts (Section 1 — Prose)

- **"An Astrologer's Day" — R.K. Narayan:** A short story about a fake astrologer who unknowingly meets a man from his past, exploring themes of fate, guilt, and irony.
- **"Indian Civilization and Culture" — M.K. Gandhi:** An essay reflecting on the spiritual depth and unique values of Indian civilization compared to Western materialism.
- **"The Secret of Work" — Swami Vivekananda:** A motivational discourse on performing work selflessly (Nishkama Karma) without attachment to results.
- **"My Struggle for an Education" — Booker T. Washington:** An autobiographical account of the author's determination and hardships in pursuing education despite poverty.

| Prescribed Texts (Section 2 — Poetry)

- **"Where the Mind is Without Fear" — Rabindranath Tagore:** A prayer-like poem envisioning an ideal nation free from fear, narrow-mindedness, and division.
 - **"Ode on Solitude" — Alexander Pope:** Reflects the poet's desire for a simple, contented life away from worldly ambition.
 - **"Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening" — Robert Frost:** Uses the imagery of a snowy forest to reflect on duty, beauty, and the pull between rest and responsibility.
 - **"A Psalm of Life" — H.W. Longfellow:** An inspirational poem urging readers to live purposefully, work hard, and leave a meaningful legacy.
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Unit 4.0 — Vocabulary and Grammar

4.1 Word Formation

- **Prefix:** Added before a root word to change its meaning. Example: un + happy = unhappy
- **Suffix:** Added after a root word. Example: happy + ness = happiness
- **Acronym:** A word formed from the initial letters of a phrase, pronounced as a word. Example: NASA, RADAR
- **Abbreviation:** A shortened form of a word/phrase, not necessarily pronounced as a word. Example: Dr., etc., Mr.

4.2 Synonyms, Antonyms, Idioms

- **Synonyms:** Words with similar meaning. Example: happy – joyful
- **Antonyms:** Words with opposite meaning. Example: happy – sad
- **Homonyms:** Words that sound alike but have different meanings/spellings. Example: bear (animal) – bare (uncovered)
- **One Word Substitution:** A single word replacing a phrase. Example: a person who cannot read = illiterate
- **Idioms and Phrases:** Fixed expressions whose meaning is figurative. Example: "break the ice" = to initiate conversation in an awkward situation

4.3 Technical Jargon

Specialized vocabulary related to a particular field/branch. For Computer Science: compiler, debugging, algorithm, firmware, syntax.

4.4 Parts of Speech

Part of Speech	Function	Example
Noun	Names a person/place/thing	Teacher, Delhi, Book
Pronoun	Replaces a noun	He, She, It
Verb	Expresses an action/state	Run, is, become
Adjective	Describes a noun	Beautiful, tall
Adverb	Modifies a verb/adjective	Quickly, very
Preposition	Shows relation of noun to other words	In, on, under
Conjunction	Joins words/clauses	And, but, because
Interjection	Expresses sudden feeling	Wow!, Oh!

4.5 Time and Tense

Tense	Form	Example
Present Simple	Subject + V1	He plays football.
Present Continuous	is/am/are + V-ing	He is playing football.
Past Simple	Subject + V2	He played football.
Past Continuous	was/were + V-ing	He was playing football.
Future Simple	will/shall + V1	He will play football.
Present Perfect	has/have + V3	He has played football.

4.6 Transformation of Sentences

- **Voice:** Active → Passive. Example: "He writes a letter." → "A letter is written by him."
- **Narration:** Direct → Indirect speech. Example: He said, "I am happy." → He said that he was happy.
- **Removal of 'Too':** Example: "He is too weak to walk." → "He is so weak that he cannot walk."
- **Question Tag:** A short question added at the end of a statement. Example: "She is coming, isn't she?"

4.7 Punctuation

Correct use of full stop (.), comma (,), question mark (?), exclamation mark (!), colon (:), semicolon (;), apostrophe ('), and quotation marks (" ") to make written text clear and grammatically correct.

Example: "Ramesh, who is my friend, lives in Patna." (commas set off a non-essential clause)

Unit 5.0 — Professional Writing

5.1 Precis Writing

A **precis** is a concise summary of a given passage, expressed in the writer's own words, retaining the essential ideas, generally reduced to about one-third of the original length, and given a suitable title.

Steps: Read the passage carefully → identify the main idea and key points → eliminate examples/repetition → write in your own words → give a suitable title → check the word limit.

5.2 Business Letters and Applications

Business Letter format: Sender's address, date, receiver's address, subject, salutation, body (introduction, content, conclusion), complimentary close, signature.

Types: Letter of inquiry, complaint letter, order letter, job application letter.

Example structure (Job Application):

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[Your Address]
[Date]

To,
The HR Manager,
[Company Name, Address]

Subject: Application for the post of ____

Sir/Madam,
[Body – introduce yourself, state purpose, qualifications, why suitable]

Yours faithfully,
[Name]
```

5.3 Drafting E-mails, Notices, Memos, Circulars

- **E-mail:** Has a Subject line, Salutation, Body, and Closing; should be concise and professional.
- **Notice:** A formal announcement displayed for a group of people, with a heading "NOTICE", date, and signature of the issuing authority.
- **Memo (Memorandum):** A short internal message used within an organization to convey instructions/information; format includes To, From, Date, Subject, and Message.
- **Circular:** A written communication sent to a number of people/departments simultaneously, usually carrying common information or instructions.

5.4 Report Writing

A **report** is a structured document presenting facts, findings, and conclusions about an event, project, or investigation.

Project Report: Typically includes Title, Introduction/Objective, Methodology, Observations/Findings, Conclusion, and Recommendations.

Event/Incident Report: Includes the title of the event, date, venue, brief description of what happened, persons involved, and outcome/observations.

Example structure:

```
REPORT ON [Event Name]

Date:           Venue:
Submitted by:
```

1. Introduction
2. Description of the Event
3. Observations
4. Conclusion